COUNTRY REPORTS: TOGO

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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Togo is governing its digital estate past the horizon of its own strategy. Togo Digital 2025, adopted in 2022 under the Ministry of Digital Economy and Transformation, covers artificial intelligence, broadband, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud services, data protection, digital identification, payments, signatures and e-commerce — and it has no adopted successor. A 2025–2030 master plan was still being drafted in May 2025, and the World Bank's 2025 index records the transformation strategy as old and due for updating, with the follow-on instrument only planned or in draft.

The priorities set out for the draft are digitisation of public services, digital entrepreneurship and startups, access for marginalised groups, cybersecurity and digital skills.

Delivery machinery exists and is running without waiting for the new document. Ministries are being digitised one at a time under a Programme de digitalisation des administrations publiques, which took the Ministry of Foreign Affairs through a four-week sprint in March 2026 after Energy and Tourism, and cybersecurity has its own National Cybersecurity Strategy running 2024–2028 alongside ANCy and CERT.tg.

What is missing is the policy that says where the state's data may sit: there is no cloud-first or cloud adoption policy governing the hosting of government data, and no government cloud or shared hosting platform meeting the index's definition.

The administrative base the strategies act on has strengthened. Effective Administration is among Togo's ten most improved governance indicators, up 21.2 points over 2014–2023 to 63.3 of 100.0 and 15th of 54 African states, and Public Administration reached 59.1 of 100.0 in 2023, 17th of 54. The finance ministry's revenue strategy for 2027 to 2031, published in September 2026, puts CFA 5,995m of its CFA 10,500m cost into digital transformation, electronic invoicing and AI-assisted risk analysis among it.

Legislation and regulation

Togo's National Assembly replaced the country's 2018 anti-money-laundering statute in its December 2025 budget session, and the new law extends customer due diligence to virtual asset service providers, bringing crypto-asset intermediaries inside the regulated perimeter for the first time while transposing updated FATF recommendations and a 2023 WAEMU directive.

The framework beneath it is settled and mostly of one vintage: the orientation law on the information society and the law on electronic transactions of 2017, the cybersecurity and cybercrime law of December 2018, the personal data protection law of 29 October 2019, and the law on biometric identification of natural persons of September 2020, which created ANID and the unique identification number; civil status still runs on a 2009 statute. The

cybersecurity statute creates the national cybersecurity agency at its own article 6, not the amendment of 24 June 2022 that revised it; a decree of February 2022 established the governance bodies overseeing the identity programme.

Much of the binding law over Togo's digital finance is made regionally rather than in Lomé: the legal base for public-treasury electronic money is Règlement n° 15/2002/CM/UEMOA and Instruction n° 008-05-2015, and authorisation is granted case by case on a dossier filed at the BCEAO's national directorate in the applicant's own state, the Bank holding three months to rule.

Four instruments moved in the summer of 2026. The Council of Ministers adopted a decree on 30 July 2026 amending table 16 of annex 2 of decree n° 2023-040/PR, the text setting the fees and royalties owed by electronic-communications operators. The National Assembly adopted in first reading on 14 August 2026 a bill authorising accession to the Hague Apostille Convention, and the Senate adopted on 21 August 2026 a reform of the commercial-courts law that completes the digitisation of procedure with an electronic platform and online hearings. The territorial administration ministry opened a review of the 2009 civil registration law in August 2026, with reform proposals expected before the end of the year. In September the Council of Ministers adopted a bill authorising ratification of the convention governing the union's Banking Commission, and the communication ministry said the 2020 Press and Communication Code would be revised to cover content creators, bloggers and influencers. E-commerce is the gap the government names itself: the trade ministry consulted businesses, regulators and consumer groups in January 2025 on reinforcing the rules, stating that the framework specific to e-commerce remained limited, and no draft text has followed on record.

BCEAO Instruction 001-01-2024 requires every payment fintech operating in the union to hold a licence or cease trading, but only about 20 payment institutions had been licensed union-wide by September 2025 and the compliance deadline had been pushed back three times.

Data protection

Togo's data protection authority began operating in March 2025 and opened with a public awareness campaign from 1 April, more than five years after the statute that created it and four after the decree of 9 December 2020 that constituted it. Its entire staff went to an induction workshop at Kpalimé from 30 July to 1 August 2026, its president describing the participants as "the very first agents of the Instance".

The regime the Instance inherits is demanding on paper. The 97-article law gazetted on 29 October 2019 creates the authority directly, in article 55, and runs a tiered set of prior formalities rather than a bare statement of rights: declaration with a one-month receipt, exemption, prior authorisation, or a reasoned opinion. Article 8 makes prior authorisation mandatory for processing biometric data, for use of a national identification number or any other general-purpose identifier, and for the interconnection of files — which is what the state's own biometric identification programme and its unique identification number do, and enrolment ran for years before the body that must authorise it existed in working form. Article 9 requires a reasoned opinion before the State may process data touching state security, criminal enforcement, the census, sensitive categories, or payroll and tax.

The law's own compliance clock — two years for processing on behalf of the State, one year for everything else — therefore expired before the regulator opened its doors. Cross-border transfer needs an adequate level of protection in the destination state plus prior notification to the authority, with an authorisation route for inadequate destinations; there is no requirement that data be stored in Togo.

The Instance's named operational units are administration and finance, compliance and communication; it gave attestations to a first cohort of 32 corporate data protection correspondents after a three-day training in June 2026, drawn from banking, insurance, telecoms, health and local government, trained around 3,000 young Togolese in digital hygiene with ANCy in November 2025, and convened ministry chiefs of staff and secretaries-general in Lomé on 15 September 2026 on their obligations under the 2019 law. The data-protection authority opened its first certification session for data protection officers on 30 September 2026, assessing 32 professionals.

Regional collaboration

The bloc whose digital instruments bind Togo does not fund them from its own budget: the ECOWAS Community budget for 2026–2028 carries no disaggregated digital or ICT appropriation anywhere in its expenditure structure, and its only ICT-named programme line, Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT, shows UA 543,953 approved in 2022 and 2023 but nil actual from 2024 and nil across the 2026, 2027 and 2028 estimates.

The instruments themselves keep arriving. ECOWAS ministers meeting at Cotonou on 4 October 2024 adopted the ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024–2029, directed member states to have the ECOWAS Roaming Regulation fully implemented by all mobile operators by the end of 2025, and adopted a directive on confidence-building measures in the cyber and ICT space to be implemented without delay upon its publication — a directive whose text has still not been published, so the obligation on Togo has never been triggered.

On identity Togo has become the reference rather than the recipient. It sits in WURI alongside Guinea, Côte d'Ivoire and Benin; Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger quit ECOWAS in 2024 and left WURI with it, building national biometric ID and self-hosted infrastructure under sovereignty policies, so the bloc-wide instruments Togo is party to no longer cover three of its Sahelian neighbours. Senegal's ministry of communication and digital economy sent a benchmarking delegation to Lomé, disclosed on 27 October 2025, with ANID presenting the technical architecture of the e-ID and how Togo integrated MOSIP, framed in Dakar as peer learning. Mutual recognition of credentials across the bloc remains a strategy validated in March 2026 rather than an operating arrangement.

In payments the reach is inward: the BCEAO runs the core WAEMU payment systems and the PI-SPI instant payment platform launched across the eight member states on 30 September 2025, which Togo participates in rather than owning a national switch. Consumer protection is being aligned with WAEMU's June 2023 directive, taken forward at a Lomé workshop on 20–21 March 2025. Togo also holds a regional chair: ARCEP's head has presided over the West Africa Telecommunications Regulators Assembly since April 2026. The Togolese and Malian data-protection authorities signed a cooperation agreement on 23 September 2026, and the Togolese and Beninese authorities held a joint working session at Lome on 2 and 3 October.

Standards

Togo gave itself a general conformity-assessment regime only this year: the Council of Ministers adopted a decree on 30 July 2026 instituting national conformity assessment of locally made and imported products before they enter the market, a standards and traceability check at the border and at the point of sale.

Inside government the position is thinner, and the document is now readable. The state's enterprise-architecture guide defines a Cadre Commun d'Interopérabilité — a duty to define and maintain, across the administration, the norms applicable to exchanges between administrations, over four levels of interoperability, and the guide's own live version page still records version 1.0, prepared by the digital agency, status Brouillon, with the version date, reviewer and review date blank and an empty revision table. No decree or order gives it force of law, while the arrangement it describes is already recorded as partially used across ministries, departments and agencies. The same agency

published a catalogue of ICT standards for government systems, validated at its fourth version in July 2023, in nine families running from security and interoperability to identity, accessibility and electronic signature, and no act adopting it is on record either.

Where shared standards do bind, they are largely borrowed. Identity rests on MOSIP, adopted under a 2021 memorandum as an open-source base rather than a proprietary imported template, and technical specifications for foundational identity systems are being harmonised region-wide under WURI. Payment standards are the central bank's: PI-SPI scheme rules are published in a public FAQ, and the BCEAO opened a public developer sandbox on 18 November 2025 with technical documentation and integration guides, letting Togolese firms verify technical compliance before building against the platform.

The national standards body, the Agence togolaise de normalisation, is a full member of the international standards organisation, and 46 national standards it drew up were disseminated at Lomé and Kara in August 2026, agri-food rather than digital.

One national reference is genuinely shared. Togo's infrastructure single window runs on CENTIPOS, a network of 25 GNSS correction stations giving centimetre-precision positioning, which also serves cadastre, precision agriculture and environmental mapping.

Assurance is the weak joint. External audits of payment and financial institutions are mandated under BCEAO prudential regulation and the OHADA accounting framework, but there is no independent public audit oversight authority and audit findings are not published. The regulator is drafting a rule requiring at least 95 per cent nationwide compliance with quality-of-service standards, with penalties (September 2026).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The space in which digital policy could be contested has narrowed while the digital estate has grown. Freedom of Association & Assembly stood at 12.5 of 100.0 in 2023, the second lowest-scoring of the 96 indicators on which Togo is measured, 30th of 54 African states and down 12.5 points over the decade, while Civil Society Space fell 17.4 points to 44.4, placing it among the ten most deteriorated.

The expression measures moved the same way. Media Freedom fell 5.2 points to 55.5 of 100.0 in 2023 and Freedom of Expression & Belief 3.4 points to 71.7, Public Perception of Freedom of Speech fell 14.6 points to 35.8, 34th of 54, and Digital Freedom fell 6.8 points to 51.3, 24th of 54. The CIVICUS Monitor rates Togo's civic space Repressed, at 29 of 100, the rating it has held since 2020 (September 2026). When protests began on 26 June 2025, Facebook, Telegram and Signal were blocked on the three main networks and YouTube and DuckDuckGo disrupted, with network measurements showing every service restored by 25 September 2025.

Government offers no general digital route in. There is no e-participation platform and none of the five further participation mechanisms tracked, and no central citizen feedback or grievance-redress platform for public services, nor any of the five further feedback mechanisms, as at 2025. What exists is sectoral: the telecoms regulator takes complaints by a call centre, mail, e-mail, messaging apps, a web form, chat and callback, and the national service portal carries a procedure letting any person over 18, resident or in the diaspora, suggest improvements to security services, administrative procedures and civil protection, with a stated examination and decision step — one ministry, and no general right to comment on a draft law or decree.

What deliberation there is on digital policy is convened outside government. ISOC Togo runs the national Internet Governance Forum, convened for Lomé on 19 June 2026 under the theme of governing in the era of AI, big data and geopolitics, its twelfth edition, held on that date, framed around a digital sovereignty its organisers define as "not isolation, but the capacities, skills and alliances to build our digital future on our own priorities", alongside a national Internet governance school, TogoSIG, and a Youth IGF track.

The right to information is complete in law and unattended in practice. The 53-article statute of 30 March 2016 sets a 30-day response period, 15 days for researchers and journalists, and vests oversight in the Médiateur de la République, implemented by a decree of 10 August 2017 running to 26 articles. Both of the index's public-records measures put Togo among its own worst-scoring indicators, and Accountability & Transparency is Togo's lowest-scoring governance sub-category, at 36.0 of 100.0 in 2023, 30th of 54, and up just 0.9 points over the decade.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Loan-financed identity and statistics projects cut the state's own share of Togo's digital budget in 2025: the 2025 budget carried XOF 8.47 billion of loan money for the WURI biometric identification project and XOF 7.79 billion for the statistics harmonisation project (FY2025), against XOF 1.81 billion and XOF 1.0 billion in 2024 (FY2024).

The digital lines of the 2025 budget came to XOF 53.0 billion appropriated, 57.1% of it on the state's own financing codes, against 80.2% of XOF 22.6 billion in 2024 (FY2025).

The 2026 budget names its external projects only through the programme document. The 2026 budget appropriates XOF 12.04 billion to the WURI project, XOF 5.0 billion to ProDigiT, XOF 6.21 billion to digitalising town halls and XOF 3.13 billion to the digital acceleration project (FY2026), the four projects the draft budget programme for 2026-2028 prints as the digital ministry's externally financed investment. The 2026 general budget prints no financing source against its other digital lines (FY2026). Its special allocation accounts, fed by non-tax receipts, carry XOF 1.37 billion for the social registry and XOF 6.85 billion for the administration modernisation programme (2026).

The running costs are appearing as lines of their own. The 2026 budget opens a XOF 46 million chapter for hosting the health information system DHIS2 and gives the state data-centre company SIN XOF 2.0 billion (FY2026), against XOF 1.5 billion for SIN in 2025 (FY2025).

The law earmarks some of the sector's own money. The 2018 cybersecurity law creates a Digital Sovereignty Fund to finance the national cybersecurity strategies and support the cybersecurity agency, leaving its operation and financing to a decree. A 2023 decree splits spectrum management royalties equally between the state budget and the regulator, and sends 30% of regulatory fines to the universal service fund.

The state's cybersecurity joint venture is financed from abroad: Poland's development bank BGK signed about EUR 24 million, the first tranche of a 12-year programme of more than EUR 80 million, for Cyber Defense Africa, the state's joint venture with Asseco Data Systems, under an EU EFSD+ guarantee (May 2026).

MoUs and other agreements

Togo and Luxembourg signed three accords in Lomé on 16 July 2026 carrying EUR 78.55 million, part of it for the digital transformation of the administration and for cybersecurity through the TogoCyber+ programme, under a new Indicative Cooperation Programme for 2026-2031 with a digital transformation component.

Agence Togo Digital took licences to three units of Kazakhstan's eGov stack from the state IT operator NITEC in June 2024 — an interoperability and services layer, a single web platform for public agencies, and an analytics tool for public governance — after a presidential visit to Kazakhstan and a ministry-level memorandum at Digital Almaty earlier that year. What was signed there is a licensing and experience-sharing arrangement rather than a financing agreement, and a licence is a permission to use rather than a commitment to deploy.

A domestic instrument is also on the record. Togo's data protection authority and the broadcast regulator HAAC signed an institutional cooperation accord on 10 December 2025 whose operative content is access: HAAC opens its control and monitoring room to the data protection authority. That is a grant of access to a broadcast monitoring facility, not a duty owed by either body.

New investments

The CFA 257.4 billion Togo signed with the World Bank Group on 16 July 2026, about USD 429 million at that date, carries one digital line: USD 20 million more for the WURI identity project.

Togo's largest single digital commitment is the World Bank's Togo Digital Acceleration Project: USD 100 million approved in December 2024, running to 2030 across broadband, public services and skills, USD 14.0 million of it disbursed at July 2026. The largest private one is the IFC's 2024 facility for Togocom: a senior A-loan of up to EUR 50 million, with B-loan co-financing taking the package above EUR 120 million, for 4G and mobile money.

Germany holds the deepest bilateral position: EUR 37.1 million from BMZ over 2022-2028, and KfW e-governance grants of EUR 20 million and EUR 15 million that run fibre to town halls, hospitals and schools to 2028. The EU's ProDigiT puts EUR 4 million into digital skills to 2030. Luxembourg's three accords of 16 July 2026, EUR 78.55 million in all, fund part of the administration's digital transformation and cyber security through TogoCyber+, with no figure attached to that part.

Germany's EUR 9.5 million public financial management project ended on 30 June 2026. Togo is also outside the World Bank's regional digital integration programme for West Africa. The United States' Millennium Challenge Corporation terminated its Togo threshold programme on 18 December 2025, with USD 11.1 million of the USD 20.5 million of its ICT project committed at 30 June 2025.

Far below, phase 2 of Togo's DHIS2 education system was financed at 71,305,244 FCFA over 2023-2024, against 8.139 billion FCFA for the IDA/GPE basic-education project and 119,493,000 FCFA to organise the June 2025 sector review.

That analytical layer costs under one per cent of the sector money beside it, and less than convening the review.

Nine digital-sector commitments are on record from 2022 to 2026, windows running out to 2034, regional operations excluded. World Bank Group entities are the largest financiers by a distance, German public finance next. Connectivity and public administration absorb almost all of it; skills training takes about one per cent. Three regional operations reach Togo, and none states a Togo-specific allocation.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Togo's mobile communications score rose 35.6 points over 2014-2023 to 71.1 of 100 — the second most improved of the 96 indicators in the Ibrahim Index — while its internet and computers score reached only 35.8 in 2023, 23rd of 54. Unique mobile subscriber penetration stood at about 78.2% of the population (2025); about 37.6% of Togolese used the internet in 2023. Price is part of the distance between those two numbers: an entry-level 1GB mobile broadband basket cost around 15.1% of monthly GNI per capita in 2020, among the five most expensive in Africa.

Since July 2021 the regulator has required a subscriber to present a national identity card or passport and to submit biometric and demographic data before a SIM is registered.

Government specification pages put the incumbent's backbone at about 1,500 km north-south at 24 fibres a link, doubled at Lomé and on two northern axes and built to reach every prefecture, the second operator's at about 800 km at 96 fibres, and the government network at about 300 km linking over 600 public buildings in Lomé, its core lifted from 10 to 100 Gbit/s — figures dated only by the page's own price validity of February 2023, so a floor. Lomé is one of eight landing points on the West Africa submarine cable built by Maroc Telecom, in service since 2021-22; Equiano, connected at Lomé in 2022 with services from 2023, was the one modern cable still serving the region when four others failed in March 2024, and a terrestrial route from Lagos to Accra through Togo and Benin was commissioned in May 2025 by the Togolese joint venture of the state infrastructure company and a pan-African operator, with partners, as an inland path for the next subsea failure. The country's one exchange point, TGIX in Lomé, carries nine member networks and 18 Gbps of port capacity, seven of the nine peering at the route server and five validating route origins, with no measurement anchor (July 2026). A World Bank programme approved in December 2024 is connecting public institutions to broadband, and a KfW grant programme running 2024-2028 extends the fibre network to town halls, hospitals and schools.

A decree adopted on 30 July 2026 amends the table setting the royalties owed by electronic-communications operators, with the stated aim of adapting spectrum charges to satellite services and satellite M2M traffic so that specialised operators establish in Togo and rural coverage extends to agriculture, health, environmental management and logistics. Free roaming between Togo, Senegal and Benin took effect on 24 April 2026 under the ECOWAS roaming regulation of December 2017, with incoming calls free for up to 30 consecutive days and outgoing calls and messages at the visited country's local rates, after the end-2025 deadline ECOWAS ministers had set for full implementation by all operators. Togolese rate the result more generously than the measurements do: the index's public perception of infrastructure indicator stands at 55.2 of 100 in 2023 and 12th of 54, against a measured infrastructure sub-category score of 41.3 at 22nd. The regulator's first national monitoring campaign of 2026 found neither mobile operator meeting its quality standards, at 75.15 and 54.07 per cent overall compliance.

Data Storage

Togo has no government cloud or shared hosting platform for public-sector systems, and no cloud policy governing where government data may be hosted (2025).

What it has instead is one state facility, whose envelope its operator now publishes: more than 1 MW of critical power, a 99.982 per cent availability commitment, a power usage effectiveness of 1.4, direct access to submarine routes and a local exchange point (September 2025), with no occupancy, rack count or delivered load stated anywhere. It has been operational since June 2021 and certified Tier III+, and is run by the state-owned Société d'Infrastructures Numériques, which puts the country's principal hosting capacity directly in the state's hands. A

protocol signed at Lomé on 26 May 2026 with ST Digital commits to a private-cloud service catalogue hosted in Togo, the state's first sovereign cloud offering. No hyperscale cloud provider has a presence in the country, so those services are served remotely from distant regions.

Nothing obliges data to stay. Law No. 2019-014 regulates cross-border transfers by requiring an adequate level of protection in the destination country or prior authorisation from the data protection authority, but does not require data to be stored physically in Togo. The identity system shows what that permits in practice: the e-ID records sit in an encrypted central database built on the open-source MOSIP platform and hosted on private cloud infrastructure provided by the IDEMIA/Atos consortium that delivered it.

Energy

Togo's energy minister told the National Assembly on 26 June 2026 that peak demand of about 360 MW was being met from roughly 180 MW of mobilisable domestic capacity, with imports from Ghana and Nigeria down from 110 and 115 MW to 20 and 70 MW, his account of that year's load-shedding.

Eighty-six per cent of Togolese firms experienced power outages in 2023, at an average of 2.7 a month. Access to energy is among the country's ten worst-scoring IIAG indicators, at 32.8 of 100 in 2023 and 30th of 54, despite an 8.1-point gain over the decade.

About 59.2% of the population had access to electricity in 2023, and the national figure conceals the shape of the problem: 95.0% of the urban population had access in 2023 against 30.5% of the rural population, a gap of about 64.5 percentage points. A digital economy outside Lomé is therefore being built on a grid two-thirds of rural households are not connected to.

Off-grid supply is where the state has concentrated its effort, through the CIZO pay-as-you-go solar home system programme, with tax exemptions and subsidies for rural households, and AT2ER-led mini-grid construction financed by the African Development Bank, the EU-Africa Infrastructure Trust Fund, the Sustainable Energy Fund for Africa and the government (2025). Renewables supplied around a quarter of electricity output in 2021. The cost of what is supplied has risen: the domestic post-payment tariff went to 93 CFA francs per kilowatt-hour between 31 and 120 kilowatt-hours in 2025, to shore up the utility's finances.

The World Bank approved USD 160 million on 24 June 2026 for electricity access in Togo and The Gambia, the split between the two countries not stated. The energy ministry tendered 5,200 smart-metering devices for the state utility in September 2026, bids due 28 October, with official figures putting the utility's technical and commercial losses at nearly 16 per cent.

Technical Capacity

The constraint on Togo's ambition to become a regional digitalisation and innovation hub is expertise, on the reading of the programme funding it: Germany's digital transformation programme, designed in 2022 and running to 2028, names weak public-private cooperation and patchy technical expertise on both sides as what stands in the way.

The flagship systems are supplier-built and supplier-hosted. The national e-ID database was built on the MOSIP platform by the IDEMIA/Atos consortium and runs on private cloud infrastructure that same consortium provides. Where the state does its own engineering it is at a smaller scale: the ministry of primary and secondary education recruited a StatEduc consultant and a management-information specialist in 2023 to migrate its databases from MS Access to PostgreSQL and move the school census to online entry. At the point where those systems meet the field it is people rather than software that runs out: training for inspectors was delivered years earlier and never refreshed, reached only a few staff at each level, and devices are in short supply. The state has written down who is meant to hold the skill — a five-tier model of the ministry coordinating policy, the digital agency deploying solutions and

setting standards, public institutions adopting a digital-first rule, a super-integrator training integrators on the agency's low-code platforms, and integrators — and that framework names giving itself the force of law as a step still outstanding. Against it, 80 digitalisation officers drawn from 27 ministries were certified on 12 June 2026 after three sessions from September 2025.

The picture is not uniformly weak. Effective administration is among the ten most improved of the country's IIAG indicators over 2014-2023. The independent developer base, though, is slight: Togo Developers and Python Togo, the two main open-source organisations on GitHub, count a few dozen members between them (2026), while both produce projects and run events.

Cybersecurity

On the ITU's index of national cybersecurity commitments, Togo was placed in the second tier in September 2024, one of four African states scoring between 85 and 95 of 100.

The instruments behind that score are in place. The regime rests on Law No. 2018-026 of 7 December 2018, which creates the national cybersecurity agency at article 6, defines the cybercrime offences and procedure, provides for a digital sovereignty fund and refers implementing decrees to its article 48, amended by Law No. 2022-009 of 24 June 2022; none of the article 48 decrees is held. The estate is governed by ANCy, the CERT.tg incident-response centre and a National Cybersecurity Strategy running 2024-2028. Cybersecurity is among the priorities set for the successor digital strategy covering 2025-2030, and Luxembourg's July 2026 cooperation agreements fund the security of the administration's digital infrastructure through a TogoCyber+ programme.

The duty to report an incident, however, is sharper in the regional financial rules than in national law: payment service providers and financial market infrastructure managers must notify the BCEAO of a service-interrupting incident on a fixed clock, while Togo's own data protection law imposes no equivalent breach notification. At the regional level the obligations are stalled: an ECOWAS directive on confidence-building measures in the cyber and ICT space instructed member states to implement it on publication, and as at August 2026 the text has still not been published, so nothing has been triggered.

Poland's development bank BGK signed about EUR 24 million in May 2026, the first tranche of a 12-year programme of more than EUR 80 million, for Cyber Defense Africa, the joint venture the state formed with Asseco Data Systems in 2019. The cybersecurity agency issued a call for expressions of interest on 27 August 2026 to build a national pool of cybersecurity professionals, closing on 30 October. Lomé hosted the third Grande Rencontre des Compliance & Risk Officers in July 2026, drawing participants from 46 countries to work on the role of artificial intelligence in anti-money-laundering, fraud and terrorist-financing controls.

DPI

Data Exchange

Formal interoperability protocols between Togolese government systems are not targeted for delivery until December 2028, the milestone carried in the World Bank's social assistance programme as at September 2024. The framework itself exists as a published text and not as an adopted one: the enterprise-architecture guide defines a common interoperability framework over four levels and its own version page still shows version 1.0, status Brouillon, revision log empty. What does operate is a per-convention route: an order of 10 September 2024 has a public body request social-registry data for a public-interest mission, sign a convention with the identity agency, obtain the data-protection authority's authorisation for personal data, and be logged, with the agency reporting quarterly — a procedure, not a service bus. Alongside it the government told an identity conference in April 2025

that a federated inter-administration network, RSIA, in which each institution keeps its own data and exposes services through a local security server, had been piloted since late 2024 with 15 public institutions connected; no later stage of it is on record.

What exists instead is a set of bilateral links between the systems that happened to need each other. Customs, tax administration and social insurance exchange data with other government systems, while the civil service human resource system exchanges none at all (2025). The business one-stop shop's database has been interconnected with the commerce register since January 2019, so that registering a company also registers it for tax. Togolese banks have been connected to the Revenue Office's e-services platform for tele-payment since 2016–2018. The revenue authority's exemptions platform integrates automatically with the SYDONIA/ASYCUDA customs system (September 2025). In 2021 the education ministry's DHIS2 instance pulled the historical StatEduc records into itself so that trends could be read across years.

Beyond that pilot nothing joins those pairs into a whole, and the identity number is not doing that work either: the tax identification number is a separate credential from the biometric NIU, with no automated linkage between them (2023), and identity records cannot be cross-checked against the civil registry to confirm a death. Integration of the e-ID with civil status records, the national identity card, passport and nationality systems remains at the legal and technical design stage. The electronic visa system launched in June 2022 connects to neither passport issuance nor immigration control. The open data portal opened in December 2024 centralises material from across the ministries, which publishes data rather than exchanging it.

Digital Identity and CRVS

More than six million people were registered and about 5.9 million identity cards produced when enrolment closed in the Centrale region on 26 September 2026, nearly 80 per cent of them distributed on the agency's figures, with Kara the last region to cover, from October to December 2026. More than 6 million already held a Numéro d'Identification Unique at the end of December 2025, through an enrolment campaign moving prefecture by prefecture — Golfe, then Agoè-Nyivé from 20 August 2025, Savanes, the Maritime region from 22 November 2025, Zio until 18 February 2026 and Plateaux-Ouest from May 2026. The programme's stated goal had been 8 million people registered by June 2024.

That leaves the register covering something over half the population at end-2025, and roughly three-quarters of the eight-million target.

Law No. 2020-009 of 10 September 2020 creates ANID, the NIU and the e-ID, amended in June 2022, and makes the number legal proof of identity before the public administration. Registration is not compulsory for individuals, though public bodies must record and use the NIU when they identify someone, which settles the question in practice. Enrolment captures a facial photograph, ten fingerprints and both irises, with under-fives registered on demographic data alone against a parent's number; every resident is eligible, refugees and asylum seekers included; and both are free, unlike the paper card, which reaches only a small minority of Togolese on the agency's own account.

What the number gives access to is still thin, and one compelled use has been added. A decree of 26 December 2024, gazetted 23 April 2025, requires telecom operators to collect the number for every subscriber, national or resident, to accept the identity agency's card where no other document exists, and to retain the data and report to the regulator — an obligation to collect the number, which is not the same as querying the agency to verify it. Otherwise QR-coded biometric cards are used to authenticate access to some public services (April 2026), and biometric

enrolment in the national health insurance scheme is being tied to the e-ID, where the credential is accepted rather than required. Otherwise the NIU coexists with the legacy national identity card rather than replacing it (2025), the tax number is obtained separately, and civil registration is not linked to it at all.

The system runs on the open-source MOSIP platform, adopted under a 2021 memorandum, and is built and hosted by the IDEMIA/Atos consortium on private cloud infrastructure. It is financed largely from outside, drawing about $72 million from the World Bank's regional WURI programme (2024), topped up again in July 2026. Oversight runs through the ordinary courts and the data protection authority, with no mechanism specific to identity. WURI's supervisory committee validated a cross-border interoperability strategy in March 2026 aimed at mutual recognition of credentials across ECOWAS.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Togo's pension fund made its first disbursements by bank transfer and mobile money in July 2026 and gave beneficiaries until 31 August 2026 to supply payment details or have payment interrupted.

The rails underneath are regional, not national. The BCEAO's instant payment platform PI-SPI went live across the eight WAEMU states on 30 September 2025, with three Togolese banks operational at launch; six institutions were authorised to open the service to the public in Togo by 24 February 2026; and Mixx by Yas became the first mobile wallet on the platform on 14 April 2026, bringing interoperable union-wide transfers and a merchant QR code with it. The central bank opened a public developer sandbox in November 2025 and set 30 June 2026 as the deadline for operators to finish connecting, then moved it to 30 September 2026 for banks, electronic-money issuers and payment institutions and to 30 June 2027 for microfinance institutions.

Togo held 12.55 million electronic-money accounts at the end of 2024, 6.07 million of them active, served by more than 81,000 service points, and active accounts grew 76.87% over that year, the fastest rate in the union. The market is a duopoly, Mixx on 58% against Moov's Flooz on 42%, with penetration at 57.2% and CFA 1,398 billion transacted in the third quarter of 2025. Formal banking is the part that has not moved: access to banking services remains among Togo's ten worst-scoring governance indicators, at 22.1 of 100 in 2023.

The state has been the most aggressive digitiser of payments. Novissi paid about 920,000 beneficiaries, 63% of them women, directly into mobile money accounts (2023), creating 170,278 accounts by January 2021 and lifting national mobile money penetration by around seven percentage points. The Treasury plans prepaid cards issued only to people the state pays or who owe it money (July 2026), and the revenue office launched e-TPU on 17 September 2026, an online platform on which small and micro enterprises, artisans and traders declare and pay the single business tax. On the private side, Semoa was granted the BCEAO's most complete non-bank payments licence on 29 January 2026 and Ecobank launched instant cross-border transfers with Thunes from Togo on 31 October 2025.

Registries

Togo reports that more than 99% of its land titles have been digitised and that land procedures can be completed online (2022), and only about 46,183 titles have ever been granted since colonial times, with customary tenure covering most of the country (2023) — a fully digital register of very little. Most farming households hold no form of land security (2025). The cadastre is being georeferenced, which maps the titles that exist rather than creating new ones.

The social registry rests on a decree of 24 April 2023: held electronically, carrying each person's identity number and a household number, managed, maintained and verified by the identity agency, with administrations obliged to base aid programmes on it and to keep electronic beneficiary registers, and an annual audit against the targeting rules. Coverage was effectively zero as at September 2024, against a target of half the population registered by December

2028, and it remains partially deployed (2025). Until that register works, the state's most complete population list remains the electoral one: Novissi was targeted through the voter register and telephone records for want of a social registry, that register covering 93% of the population in 2020 and more than 4.2 million voters registered for the April 2024 elections.

The 2009 civil status law requires an act for every birth, marriage and death of anyone resident in Togo, of whatever nationality, and civil registration is one of the country's best-scoring governance indicators at 75.0 of 100 in 2023, seventh of 54 African states, though it has not moved since 2014. The registers themselves remain paper: what went online in December 2025 was the request for copies of acts, in five pilot communes. Identity records cannot be cross-checked against the civil registry to confirm a death, so nothing closes the loop between the two.

Business registration is the joined-up corner: the commerce register was reissued online in 2019 as a fully digital register open to the public and the one-stop shop issues a single card carrying commerce, tax and social security numbers together. There is no operating national addressing system, the national scheme remaining under development while address databases are built in Grand Lomé, and a single window for mapping the country's underground and aerial networks opened only in April 2026.

One commune's registration application lifted births registered from 700 in 2019 to 1,975 in 2020. A Lomé commune began piloting online birth and death declaration from two health facilities in March 2024. The public-service ministry tendered technical assistance for a 16-commune digitisation pilot, bids closing 10 August 2026.

Sectoral management information systems

Returns from Togo's roughly 16,000 pre-primary, primary and secondary schools are filled in on paper and digitised only once they reach the district inspectorates, which key them into StatEduc; DHIS2 sits above that stack as the analytical layer rather than replacing it as the collection layer. What holds the system back is latency rather than technology: validated data reaches DHIS2 weeks after collection, too late to support in-year decisions at district or school level. In health the same platform is the record itself: DHIS2 has been the health ministry's information system since 2016 and is the national repository, owned and maintained by the ministry, now ingesting global climate datasets shared with the meteorological agency and serving gridded temperature, rainfall and humidity at district level. GPE's independent panel concluded in April 2024 that "one cannot yet say that Togo has a fully accessible and operational EMIS" and found no evidence of a school master list or of student identification numbers. The ministry set the collection layer moving in 2023, migrating StatEduc from MS Access to PostgreSQL and taking the school census to online entry.

The back office is in better shape. Financial management, tax administration, customs, human resources, social insurance and pensions, debt management and electronic procurement are all recorded as in use, with payroll the one core system absent (2025), though the financial management system reaches central government only. The finance ministry ran a web-based budget system, SOLAF, in parallel with the older integrated system through 2024 and trained 236 regional authorising officers in it, with a decision on a full switch due at the year's end; no decision is on record.

Four of the six of those systems whose software type is recorded — financial management, tax, human resources and social insurance — are custom-built, against commercial products for customs and debt management (2025).

The revenue authority's nationwide tax census enumerated 65,958 economic units to March 2022, of which only 7.7% of those answering held a valid tax identification number, which is the measure of what a working tax system is administering. In health, immunisation data entry runs through DHIS2 and has been decentralised to facility level (2024), one of the few clinical streams captured digitally where care is given, and an electronic community health

information system went live in the Maritime Region in 2024. Policing and criminal justice run the other way: the West Africa Police Information System has operated since 2022 from a central unit in Lomé rather than at rural facilities, and the criminal procedure code requires officers to draft and sign procès-verbaux and to keep physical custody registers on site, so case data starts on paper as a matter of law. Commercial and civil justice in Lomé are the exception: the commercial court's SYSCOM platform takes electronic filing, notifies and enrols appeals and transfers appealed files to the court of appeal, whose commercial chambers it reached in February 2025, and fees for about forty services of the Lomé high court have been payable online since 2 July 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Togo's public service portal carried 101 online services as of December 2025. It is the National Portal for Digitalised Administrative Procedures, run by the Togo Digital Agency, on which citizens open authenticated accounts using national identity documents, with a companion Gouv Check app that verifies the QR codes on the documents it issues. The portal is transactional rather than informational, and citizens are recorded as having been involved in its design (2025).

Citizens of five pilot communes have been able to request copies of birth, marriage and death records online and track them in real time since 15 December 2025, and the energy ministry added 29 procedures covering the utility, the rural electrification agency and the regulator at the same time. The investment promotion agency has moved twelve company-establishment procedures onto the single window (2024). Taxpayers can register, file and pay online, a channel compulsory for large and medium enterprises since 15 October 2019, and its exemptions platform became mandatory on 1 January 2026. An electronic visa has been available since June 2022, government procurement publishes tender notices and awards online, with fully electronic procurement only at the strategy stage in October 2025, and the volunteering agency's four programmes can be browsed, joined and tracked from a mobile app (July 2026).

Delivery is by ministry rather than by service: the administration is being digitised one department at a time, the foreign affairs ministry taking a four-week sprint in March 2026 covering connectivity, internal processes, electronic mail and document management, after energy and tourism. The public administration service-delivery modernisation project was confirmed operational in July 2026, and the finance ministry began running electronic document management and back-file digitisation from April 2026.

A citizen can answer back only one agency at a time. There is no central feedback or grievance-redress platform for public services, nor any of the five further mechanisms the index tracks, nor artificial intelligence in citizen-facing services, and no e-participation platform either (2025); the portal does host the security ministry's platform for reporting abuses by the security forces, opened in January 2025. The social protection service portal is still being implemented. The foreign ministry put ten administrative procedures on the national portal from 1 October 2026, and the communication ministry put ten services of the state broadcasters online. The Council of Ministers authorised the justice minister to set up an online repository of Togolese case law. The Council of Ministers adopted a visa decree updating the regime digitised in 2022, with new categories and stronger personal-data protection.

A trade-facilitation alliance launched a project in Lomé on 9 October 2026 to digitalise the plant import permit for the agricultural production directorate, funded by the European Union and the German Government.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The digital state below the national level is five communes deep. Since December 2025 an online portal has let citizens of Agoè-Nyivé 1, Golfe 1, Avé 2, Zio 2 and Lacs 1 request copies of civil-status documents and track processing in real time, and those communes received computer equipment in April 2026.

The money behind municipal digitalisation is German. KfW is financing a EUR 20 million grant programme running 2024-2028 that extends the fibre network and connects town halls, hospitals and schools to it, while strengthening the capacity and equipment of the municipal administrations it targets. A second phase commits a further EUR 15 million over 2025-2028 to municipal service quality, administrative transparency and further connections. Germany's public financial management programme ended on 30 June 2026 and its successor moves to communal and regional financial governance in the Savanes and Kara regions.

Education is the one system that reaches down. Togo has run a DHIS2-based education management information system nationally since 2019, built with GPE KIX and Norad support, whose dashboards cover enrolment, teacher-pupil ratios and exam results and push analysis out to district and school actors; it succeeded a statistical package whose thin analytical tools left sub-national actors dependent on centrally produced analyses. It works best at regional level, where staff use dynamic tables, dashboards and maps to decide where to send teachers and which schools to build. Lower down it thins: validated data reaches the system weeks after collection, too late for in-year decisions at district or school level, and training reached few staff and was never refreshed, with devices in short supply.

Togo has no operating national addressing system: the national scheme remains under development, with address databases so far only in Grand Lomé. On whether rural populations have a voice in decisions affecting them, the Ibrahim Index scores Togo 62.2 of 100.0 in 2023, its weakest rural measure at 32nd of 54 despite a 4.8-point gain over the decade.

Doufelgou 1 and Sotouboua 2 validated taxpayer files of 597 and 991 taxpayers built with the SIG Recettes application in March 2025. Bassar 1 validated a census of 1,358 taxpayers the same month. Golfe 2, in Greater Lomé, launched a georeferenced census of households, businesses and taxpayers on 11 August 2026, running to 10 October.

Rural digital data capture

Digital capture outside Lomé happens where a programme has put it there, and hardly at all as routine administration. Biometric identity enrolment has worked through the prefectures in phases, opening in Maritime region Zone 1 from November 2025, running as mass enrolment in Zio to February 2026 and preparing the Plateaux-Ouest prefectures in May 2026. The agriculture ministry is digitising producer registries for five strategic value chains with technicians capturing data on smartphones in the field, and community health workers in the Maritime Region have reported through an electronic community health information system since 2024.

The two largest routine flows are still on paper. Data from Togo's pre-primary, primary and secondary schools is filled in on paper at the school and keyed into a statistical application only once the forms reach the district education inspectorates; at gendarmerie posts, the criminal procedure code requires officers to draft and sign procès-verbaux and to keep physical custody registers on site.

On the Ibrahim Index's ratings of rural sector policy Togo does comparatively well. Rural Economy is one of its three best-scoring sub-categories at 63.6 of 100.0 in 2023, up 7.8 points over the decade though only 25th of 54 on the continent, and two rural measures sit among the country's ten most improved: Rural Land & Water Access rose 22.9

points over 2014-2023 to 62.9 of 100.0, and Rural Economy Support 20.9 points to 66.5. Rural Market Access moved the other way, falling 17.3 points to 63.0 of 100.0 by 2023 — the only rural measure to decline while the rest of the sub-category rose.

What can be captured still runs ahead of what is connected. Most of the rural population was without an electricity connection in 2023, against near-universal access in the towns, and the land title register has never covered more than a small minority of holdings. A July 2026 amendment to spectrum royalties was framed as drawing satellite and machine-to-machine operators into Togo so that rural connectivity extends to agriculture, health, environmental management and logistics.

Technology

AI

Togo's artificial intelligence work is a laboratory and a language programme rather than an adopted national strategy: Voix du Togo was launched in October 2026 as a three-year programme collecting voice and text in Ewe, Kabiye and Moba first, to train models for the national languages, the open-source national programme for the country's 50 languages run by the Togo AI Lab.

The lab itself is a ministry initiative run with the University of California Berkeley's Center for Effective Global Action, the Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, IDF and Germany's GIZ ProDigiT programme, delivering the language project with the pan-African data-science platform Zindi and the Togolese startup Umbaji. What has begun is data collection rather than model training. The programme sets a per-language target of 50 hours of validated audio recordings and 6,000 translated sentence pairs, to be gathered through four Zindi competitions carrying about $40,000 in prizes (July 2026) — a corpus-building exercise across a set of languages that has almost no machine-readable text behind it.

The framing is deliberate and sovereign rather than frontier. Digital minister Cina Lawson calls national-language models "essential public infrastructure", a position Togo took to the AI for Good summit in Geneva, and the same theme carries the national Internet Governance Forum, convened for Lomé in June 2026 around governing in the era of AI, big data and geopolitics. AI is one of the domains named in the Togo Digital 2025 strategy, adopted in 2022 for a horizon to 2025, and advanced degrees in the field are under development at the École Polytechnique de Lomé (2026).

Inside government, nothing is running. The World Bank's 2025 index records no artificial intelligence in citizen-facing public services, and the country's one deployed model predates the lab: machine learning over mobile-phone metadata and satellite data to decide who received Novissi cash payments (2023). The local-language AI pilot gathers voice and text through paid public contributions, with UNDP support.

ICT Industry

The state's own reading of the domestic sector is that it barely touches the domestic economy: the great majority of Togolese firms are micro, small or medium, and only a small minority of them use digital tools at all (June 2026). The response is a supply-side one. Agence Togo Digital launched a digital-maturity toolbox for small firms in June 2026 — a diagnostic, a catalogue of solutions, certified advisors and a resource library — funded through GIZ's ProDigiT programme with German, Luxembourgish and EU backing, against a Togo Digital 2025 target of 3,000 firms digitised that the strategy's own horizon has now outrun.

A domestic sector does exist, and it is young rather than absent. The digital economy was about 4% of GDP in 2022, against a target of 10%, with a new strategy in preparation for 2025–2030. The firms behind that share are Togolese-owned and consumer-facing — the startups that founded the industry body TogoTech employ a few hundred people between them at most — with Gozem's venture raises the sector's largest by a distance.

Where the state and the banks buy technology, the supplier is more often foreign or donor-financed. The single-window digitisation of twelve company-establishment procedures by the investment agency API-ZF (2024) sits alongside a small-firm programme paid for by German cooperation; Lomé-headquartered Ecobank built its instant cross-border service on the rails of the Singaporean fintech Thunes (October 2025); and the hosting market has attracted enough outside interest to carry a dedicated data-centre market briefing (July 2025). The constraint under all of it is power: most firms reported outages in the World Bank's 2023 enterprise survey.

Innovation ecosystem

Togo ranks 117th of 133 economies in the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024 with a score of 15.6, third among low-income economies behind Rwanda and Madagascar — a low absolute position that is a strong relative one for a country of its income.

Production is real but narrow. Trackers count a few hundred registered startups, of which only a small minority have raised external money (2025), and one firm accounts for most of the capital: the ride-hailing and super-app company Gozem raised a $30 million Series B in February 2025 and a further $15 million later that year, with development finance institutions rather than private venture capital still doing most of the investing. The sector organised itself in the same period, launching the industry body TogoTech in Lomé in October 2025 with around 15 firms — Gozem, Semoa, Édolé, MiaPay and Clinicaa among them — to speak with one voice, working through partnerships including the cybersecurity operator Cyber Defense Africa and legal firms.

The public infrastructure for new firms is being built downwards from the capital. Djanta Tech Hub in Lomé, funded by the World Bank under the Digital Transformation Acceleration Project, runs structured pre-incubation and incubation cohorts with CcHub and is intended as the first of a planned network of more than 100 hubs (2025), and the World Bank's 2025 index records both a strategy and a running programme for public sector innovation, with collaboration between the public and private sectors on it.

Absorption shows most clearly in payments, where the regulator has opened its own systems to outside builders: the BCEAO's public developer sandbox for instant payments (November 2025) lets Togolese firms build against the national platform, Semoa won the most complete non-bank payments licence in January 2026, and Gozem Money entered service in October 2025. Against that, the design documents of Germany's 2022–2028 digital transformation programme name weak public-private cooperation and thin technical expertise on both sides as the thing standing between Togo and its stated ambition to be a regional innovation hub.

Capacity

Literacy

Education completion is among the ten most improved indicators in Togo's governance record of the past decade, rising 22.0 points over 2014-2023 to 58.6 of 100.0 and 16th place of 54 African countries, and carrying the wider education score up 10.1 points to 54.8 and 24th of 54 (2023).

The gains are uneven in a specific way. Equality in education — how evenly provision reaches different groups and regions — is the best-ranked of Togo's education measures at 63.9 of 100.0 and 12th of 54, and it is also the one that went backwards over the decade, down 2.6 points (2023). The teaching workforce is the weakest by rank, at 50.3 of 100.0 and 35th of 54 despite a 22.8-point rise, with enrolment and education quality both sitting at 48.7 (2023).

Being able to read is not the same as being able to reach a service that has to be read on a screen. 18% of Togolese owned a computer and 32% had a phone that could reach the internet, with 18% often getting their information over the internet (January 2021).

Work on that second literacy has begun from the data-protection side rather than the education side. The personal data authority opened with a public awareness campaign from April 2025 aimed at building a digital space of trust, and has since run basic digital hygiene training for young Togolese with the national cybersecurity agency (November 2025). Inside government, the ministry's own education data runs on DHIS2 (2024).

Training and skills

Togo's education data system is held back by people rather than software: at inspection level, the training was delivered years earlier and never refreshed, reached only a few staff at each level, and devices are in short supply, while the observation tools ask more of an inspector than a single classroom visit allows (May 2026).

Most of what else is on the record is short and event-shaped. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs trained 280 agents in cybersecurity and digital tools as part of a digitisation sprint (March 2026). The data protection authority has trained a first cohort of 32 corporate data protection correspondents drawn from banking, insurance, telecoms, local government, health and transport (June 2026), and has put its own staff through an induction workshop on its legal framework, its procedures and its budget (August 2026). Across the public service there is a digital skills programme covering advanced digital skills and data literacy, with the training free to take (2025), and it now has a figure behind it: 80 digitalisation officers drawn from 27 ministries and selected from 1,442 candidates were certified at Lomé on 12 June 2026, after three sessions between September 2025 and June 2026 covering project and product management, leadership and artificial-intelligence tools.

The standing institutions are fewer and older. IAI-Togo has taught computing in Lomé since 2002 as part of a pan-African higher-education network, and the Ecole Polytechnique de Lomé is building advanced degrees in engineering mathematics, computer science, artificial intelligence and data science with French development funding and a partner university in Troyes (2026). Alongside them the national internet governance forum runs a governance school, TogoSIG, and a youth track (June 2026), and the government's Djanta Tech Hub in Lomé runs pre-incubation and incubation cohorts (2025). Two new routes opened in 2026: the university joined the Campus 42 peer-learning network on 25 and 26 April, teaching programming and artificial intelligence with no instructors or lectures and open to people without conventional academic backgrounds, and a first artificial-intelligence summer school trained 100 students, researchers and young professionals from 24 to 29 August.

Two large external commitments carry the money for skills. The World Bank's Togo Digital Acceleration Project funds digital skills training among its four components through to 2030 (2024), and the European Union's ProDigiT is aimed squarely at the limited skills base that constrains the digital transformation of the economy, running to 2030 (2024). The data-protection authority and the Universite de Kara signed a convention for a professional master's in digital law, cybersecurity and data protection (2026).

Research institutions

The clearest case of knowledge being made in Togo rather than brought in is language data: an open-source national programme to build artificial-intelligence models for the country's 50 national languages, among them éwé, mina, kabyè, tem, moba and bassar, run by the Togo AI Lab (July 2026).

The lab shows the shape of the arrangement. It is a ministry initiative run with the University of California Berkeley's Center for Effective Global Action, the Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, IDF and Germany's GIZ, delivering the language project with the pan-African data science platform Zindi and the Togolese startup Umbaji (July 2026), with its collection targets set at launch and the data to be gathered through prize competitions. Togolese material and Togolese participants; the funding and the method come from outside.

The same pattern holds where systems are built. The education management information system was built by HISP West and Central Africa with Norwegian and Global Partnership for Education funding, for the ministry of primary and secondary education.

Measured output is low. Togo ranks 117th of 133 economies in the 2024 Global Innovation Index with a score of 15.6, third among low-income economies behind Rwanda and Madagascar (2024).

Where higher education touches the field it does so as teaching rather than as research. IAI-Togo has trained computing graduates in Lomé since 2002, and the Ecole Polytechnique de Lomé's advanced degrees in artificial intelligence and data science are still being developed with a French partner university (2026).

Inclusion

Access to services

Togo ranks 9th of 54 African states on the IIAG's measure of how evenly public services reach different groups, at 59.2 of 100.0 in 2023, up 12.9 points over 2014–2023. Evenness is not depth. Access to banking services remains among the country's ten worst-scoring indicators on the same index (2023) even as 6.07 million electronic-money accounts were active at the end of 2024, and Togolese report that identity documents are not easy to obtain, a perception that has slipped since 2014.

The identity system removes several barriers by design. Enrolment and the credential are free, where the old paper card carried a fee, eligibility extends in law to anyone staying temporarily or permanently in the country, refugees and asylum seekers included, children can be registered from birth on a parent's number, and the 2009 civil status law requires an act for every birth, marriage and death of any resident, of whatever nationality. Registration itself is not compulsory, but administrations are obliged to record and use the number, which makes it the way in to a widening range of services. In practice refugees are documented on a separate system: the national refugee body records 41,773 Burkinabé granted refugee status after four registration operations between 2023 and 2025, and 10,972 refugee identity cards produced and distributed across the Savanes between 22 May and 16 July 2025, with a US$1 million grant approved on 4 August 2026 funding registration and documentation of 5,000 new arrivals in a region now hosting more than 55,000 refugees and close to 16,000 internally displaced people — none of it on the national identity register. A prefectural official in Plateaux-Ouest described the absence of recognised proof of identity as a barrier to essential services there (May 2026), and the UN Committee on the Rights of the Child has raised barriers to nationality and a residual statelessness risk for children of refugee parents (2023).

The online routes exist and are narrow. Civil-status documents can be requested and tracked online in five pilot communes (December 2025); tax registration, filing and payment and vacancy search and job applications run through portals in use, and the national service portal is transactional rather than informational (2025). The social

protection portal is still being implemented and not yet in use, and there is no central grievance or feedback channel for public services (2025). The routes to complain are service by service: abuses by the security forces can be reported online since January 2025, and the health insurer opened an online platform for filing and tracking complaints on 27 March 2026.

Digital divides

Togo's switch to paying pensions by bank transfer and mobile money names no route for a beneficiary who has no bank account, no handset or no mobile coverage, and the two support channels offered for the switch — a freephone number and a messaging app — both presuppose the connectivity at issue (August 2026). Because payment is interrupted for those who do not supply details in time, the missing offline route is a question of income rather than convenience.

The lines that switch runs along are well mapped. Electricity access splits sharply between town and country (2023), and internet use remains a minority activity (2023). The IIAG scores Togo far lower on internet and computers than on mobile communications (2023), which is the gap between holding a phone and holding a device with a connection; when Afrobarometer last asked, computer ownership and internet-capable handsets were both minority holdings (January 2021). Mobile data is expensive against income (2020), which puts a price on each of those connections.

Where the state can see these divides it sees them unevenly. The education MIS reports enrolment, teacher–learner ratios and exam results broken down by gender and by disability status, a disaggregation with no counterpart in most other services, while the evenness of educational provision is one of the few education measures to have gone backwards over the decade (2023). Biometric enrolment for the e-ID has run region by region rather than nationwide (2025), and Kara, the last region, is to be covered from October to December 2026, so which region a person lives in still bears on whether they have been enrolled at all.

Data

National statistics

Togo's Capacity of the Statistical System score reached 64.2 of 100.0 in 2023, up 13.4 points over the decade and ninth of 54 African states — one of only two measures on which the country reaches the continental top ten outside women's equality and security.

The strength is uneven in an instructive way. The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators put Togo above 89% on data use and between 70% and 89% on data products in 2023, but at only 50–69% on statistical services and infrastructure and 20–49% on data sources, its weakest pillar. Over the decade to 2023 Togo fielded three or more household surveys, two health surveys, one agricultural survey and one labour force survey, and no business survey at all, and while a population census and a business census fall within the past ten years, the most recent agricultural census falls only within the past twenty.

Collection is being restarted at both ends. Field preparation for a third harmonised household living-conditions survey opened on 9 February 2026, the survey running in the field to December 2026, and a fourth demographic and health survey launched on 13 March 2026 over 385 clusters and about 10,000 households, the first such round since 2013-2014, with results expected in 2027. The strategy above them has lapsed: the second national statistics development strategy was adopted on 27 August 2020 for 2020 to 2024 and the statistics council adopted strategic orientations for the statistical system at its thirteenth ordinary session (July 2026), with no successor strategy on record.

Sector reporting can be fast: education statistical yearbooks are published within three months of the end of the school year, alongside a 2019 country status report and MICS-EAGLE and Data Must Speak analyses. What sits beneath them is slower. School returns are still captured on paper and keyed in at the district inspectorates, validated figures reach the national analytical layer weeks after collection, and an independent panel concluded in April 2024 that the sector's data function was not yet fully accessible and operational.

The statistical institute's remit runs wider than statistics: INSEED manages the deployment of field personnel for the biometric identity enrolment campaigns. Census data is also one of the categories the 2019 data protection law places behind a reasoned opinion from the data protection authority before the state may process it. And the tax authority's own nationwide census of economic units, published in December 2022, found the great majority of them outside the tax register.

Open data

The Togo Digital Agency launched an open data platform, opendata.gouv.tg, and a geoportal, geodata.gouv.tg, in December 2024, centralising data from 23 ministries and over 550 administrative units for planning across education, health and infrastructure. The World Bank's 2025 review found the government portal updated weekly or daily but carrying basic datasets rather than a comprehensive catalogue, and populated mostly by hand rather than automatically from source systems.

Openness of the underlying statistics is middling and lopsided. The Open Data Inventory's 2024 scores put economic and financial data highest — balance of payments and money and banking at 7 of 10, prices at 6.5, government finance and national accounts at 5.5 each, with trade at 3.5 and labour at 4.5. Social statistics run from education outcomes at 7 down to health outcomes, food security and crime at 4 each, with poverty, gender and reproductive health at 5 and population at 4.5. Environmental data is weaker still, from built environment at 6 to pollution at 3, the lowest of any scored category.

Across the twenty-two categories carrying a 2024 score, the mean is 5.0 of 10, nine categories score below 5, and none scores above 7.

The right to ask stands on firmer ground than the right to receive, and firmer in law than in practice. The 2016 access-to-information statute and its 2017 implementing decree are in force with oversight vested in the Médiateur, and the same 2025 review records an established data governance function led by an autonomous institution, with a further instrument in progress. Yet both of the Ibrahim Index's public-records measures sit among Togo's ten worst-scoring indicators: disclosure of public records at 24.2 of 100.0 in 2023, 39th of 54 and up 0.8 points over the decade, and accessibility of public records at 28.5, 30th of 54 and up 4.7. They belong to the sub-category Togo scores lowest of all in 2023, accountability and transparency.

Publication has gone furthest where it is transactional rather than statistical: tender notices and awarded contracts are published online, and the commercial register has opened firms' legal and financial data to the public since its 2019 online release.

Use of satellite data

The state's most consequential use of satellite data was to decide who got paid: the Novissi emergency transfer programme identified recipients by applying machine learning to mobile phone metadata and satellite data, reaching most of its beneficiaries on that basis (2023). Imagery has since moved from forecast to payment. Under the food-system resilience programme the meteorological agency was equipped with a satellite image reception antenna and new agrometeorological stations, with agro-hydro-climatic forecasts pushed to producers by SMS and voice call; on 7 and 8 April 2026 index-insurance claims resting on satellite analysis and climate data were paid to producers in

three agricultural zones; and the government's data laboratory tracks agricultural plots from imagery and trains models forecasting maize and sorghum production. There is no Togolese satellite, and the rest of the estate is anchored in positioning rather than imagery. Togo's infrastructure single window runs on CENTIPOS, a national network of 25 GNSS correction stations giving centimetre-precision positioning, which also serves the cadastre, precision agriculture and environmental mapping. Its most developed application is land: the Directorate of Cadastre and Land Conservation is modernising the cadastre through a georeferencing programme for land titles, adding a digital cadastral layer alongside the digitised titles (2025). The digital minister announced an earth-observation cooperation under which Kyrgyzstan is to transmit satellite data for agriculture and train local staff (2026).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The American presence in Togo's digital sector runs through a university research centre and a private foundation rather than a commercial platform: the Togo AI Lab, a ministry initiative, is run with the University of California Berkeley's Center for Effective Global Action and the Patrick J. McGovern Foundation alongside IDF and Germany's GIZ ProDigiT programme, and it delivers its national-language AI project with the pan-African data-science platform Zindi and the Togolese startup Umbaji (July 2026). Google.org committed USD 2 million in December 2025 to scale the Togo Data Lab, run by the digital ministry with the Berkeley centre. The Millennium Challenge Corporation terminated its Togo threshold programme, which carried a USD 20.5 million ICT project, on 18 December 2025. No US hyperscaler operation in Togo was on the public record as at August 2026.

China activities

Togo's one standing Chinese digital instrument is a strategic partnership protocol concluded with Huawei in the margins of the China-Africa forum in September 2024, signed for Togo by the trade minister to strengthen cooperation in information and communication technology — its text unpublished, with no amount, scope or timetable stated. No Chinese-financed digital infrastructure project in Togo is on the public record. Later engagement has been broad rather than digital-specific. Togolese officials toured China's G60 science and technology corridor on 31 July 2026 during a seminar run by the Chinese commerce ministry, and the thirteen accords signed in Beijing on 15 October 2026 include a commitment to deepen cooperation on digital commerce and supply chains, a customs Authorised Economic Operator protocol between the revenue office and China's customs administration, and partnerships between China Media Group and the state broadcaster; none of the texts is published.

EU activities

Germany's public financial management programme in Togo, worth EUR 9.5 million and implemented by GIZ, ended on 30 June 2026 after a closing workshop in Lomé on 19 May 2026, and its successor moves to a different tier of the state — communal and regional financial governance in the Savanes and Kara regions — so it does not carry forward the central-government digital PFM tools, and no mechanism, budget line or owning agency has been named to sustain them (May 2026).

The standing European instrument is ProDigiT, which commits EUR 4 million over 2024-2030 to the digital skills base that constrains Togo's digital economy, framed against the government's Togo 2025 roadmap and the Global Gateway strategy. It is delivered by GIZ and backed by Germany, Luxembourg and the EU together, and it funded Agence Togo Digital's digital-maturity toolbox for micro, small and medium firms (June 2026), which offers a maturity diagnostic, a catalogue of solutions, certified advisors and a resource library. ProDigiT is also among the backers of the Togo AI Lab.

European money reaches well beyond the digital ministries. The agriculture ministry is digitising producer registries for its strategic value chains with EU and GIZ support under the ProComp programme, and the EU-Africa Infrastructure Trust Fund is among the financiers of AT2ER's mini-grid construction, alongside the African Development Bank, the Sustainable Energy Fund for Africa and the government. Luxembourg signed three cooperation agreements in Lomé on 16 July 2026, part of which funds the digital transformation of the Togolese administration and the security of its digital infrastructure through the TogoCyber+ programme, with a dedicated digital transformation component in the Indicative Cooperation Programme for 2026-2031.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf-state investment in Togo's digital infrastructure was on the public record as at August 2026.

India activities

No Indian digital cooperation programme in Togo was on the public record as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Togo's data-protection authority has made in-country storage its stated goal: its head said in January 2026 that the final objective is to require digital operators to store Togolese personal data in Togo, while the authority already receives requests to authorise transfers of personal data abroad. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026.

The state's own facility has been run by others. Management of the state-owned Lomé Data Centre was given to Africa Data Centres for five years from 2021, with an obligation to transfer skills to Togolese staff so that the state could eventually run it itself; Cabinet authorised its cession to a private operator in December 2022, and the minister said in July 2023 that it was still looking for an investor-operator. Social insurance keeps its data in a state facility: the health insurer INAM's new information system is hosted on the social security fund CNSS's own data centre, a pooling the two present as keeping the data sovereign (April 2026).

The national identity database is hosted on private cloud infrastructure provided by the IDEMIA/Atos consortium that built it. Where the IDEMIA/Atos private cloud that hosts the national identity database is located, and under whose jurisdiction, had not been published as at September 2026. The terms on which the IDEMIA/Atos contract, the NITEC licences and the SIN protocol with ST Digital govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The AI layer is being built in the country with outside money. UNDP's September 2026 review of its AI infrastructure programme lists Togo among six African countries where it procured and deployed country-hosted GPU compute, and Google.org's US$2 million for the Togo Data Lab, run by the digital ministry with Berkeley's CEGA, is to train 27 data specialists for the ministries (December 2025).

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